

SENATE RESOLUTION 427

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to commend and congratulate Lauren Milam upon her receipt of the Dennis Washington Leadership Graduate Scholarship.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we recognize those industrious, talented students of Tennessee who bring pride and honor to our State; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Lauren Milam, who has the great distinction of being named a 2026 recipient of the Dennis Washington Leadership Graduate Scholarship; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Milam is one of only five students nationwide to receive this highly competitive award, which provides up to \$250,000 for graduate study; and

WHEREAS, the Horatio Alger Association of Distinguished Americans, Inc., is a nonprofit organization that honors leaders who have overcome adversity and supports young people in furthering their education; and

WHEREAS, endowed in 2008 and funded by the Dennis and Phyllis Washington Foundation in partnership with the Horatio Alger Association, the Dennis Washington Leadership Graduate Scholarship invests in exceptional individuals with leadership potential who are striving to make a significant impact in their respective fields; and

WHEREAS, as of 2025, the program has awarded more than \$11.8 million in graduate scholarships to 148 Horatio Alger Alumni Scholars over seventeen years; and

WHEREAS, applicants for the Dennis Washington Leadership Graduate Scholarship must have a minimum 3.0 GPA; demonstrate leadership, integrity, and perseverance in overcoming adversity; and show a commitment to entrepreneurship and community service; and

WHEREAS, Lauren Milam was selected from a competitive pool of Horatio Alger Alumni Scholars based on academic excellence, leadership, and a demonstrated commitment to overcoming adversity; and

WHEREAS, a Waynesboro native and an alumnus of the University of Tennessee at Martin, Lauren Milam is pursuing an MD/MBA at East Tennessee State University's Quillen College of Medicine; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Milam's recent honor is a great source of pride for her family, her school, and her community; and

WHEREAS, her display of aptitude and ambition surely bodes well for her future success, and her dedication to excellence is clearly deserving of our respect, admiration, and commendation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we commend and congratulate Lauren Milam on being named a 2026 Dennis Washington Leadership Graduate Scholarship recipient, extending our best wishes for much continued success in all her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.